

07/31/26

Free Talk

The boss of ... xxx 的老大

Tipping culture 消费文化

Service charge / fee 服务费

Grocery shopping 买菜 (根据语境来翻译, 也可以是买日用品)

Bio (biologisch 德语) - organic 有机的

The way to produce the ingredients - 尽量不用化学合成农药

Deep-sea seafood 深海海鲜

Parasite 寄生虫

Homework Analysis

Question 1 (f) Summary

Read **Text B**, *Who or what is Sophie the giraffe?*, in the insert and answer **Question 1(f)** on this question paper.

- (f) According to **Text B**, what is appealing about Sophie the giraffe to modern parents of young children?

You must **use continuous writing** (not note form) and **use your own words** as far as possible.

Your summary should not be more than 120 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing.

第二次修改

Modern parents are attracted to Sophie because she is made especially for babies and is easy for little hands to hold. She is also stylish and widely recognised, making her a popular choice for families. Many children quickly become emotionally attached to her and take her everywhere. Parents trust her because she is still produced by hand in the original French factory using safe, non-toxic paint. As she is made from natural rubber that does not harm trees, she is environmentally friendly. Sophie also encourages babies to use their senses through her colours, texture, sound and smell. Besides the classic toy, many matching products are available, and the original version has received awards.

Content: 10/10

已涵盖的内容:

1. specially designed for young children → made especially for babies
2. fashionable / famous / on social media → stylish and widely recognised
3. children become attached / companion → children quickly become emotionally attached... take her everywhere
4. same small French factory → still produced by hand in the original French factory
5. food-grade paint / safe → safe, non-toxic paint
6. natural rubber / environmentally friendly → natural rubber... environmentally friendly
7. engages five senses → encourages babies to use their senses...
8. range of products → many matching products are available
9. classic / vintage → Besides the classic toy...
10. awards / movie → has received awards

未写到的内容:

1. visually attractive / friendly-looking → Forrest写了 stylish, 更接近 fashionable, 但没有提外观吸引人

Before my daughter was even born, my parents (who lived in Europe at that time) started sending presents for her. The first one to arrive was a 'Sophie the Giraffe' – a friendly-looking giraffe toy.

2. celebrity fans / royal fans / big events → 完全无提及

Writing: 4/5

In general: 语言自然/句型多样/衔接不错/几乎没有语法问题~

1. Forrest: Parents trust her because she is still produced by hand in the original French factory using safe, non-toxic paint.

分析: by hand? 原文其实没有说这一点, 而是说 “made in the same small French factory.” Forrest自己推断啦!

没有说到“by hand”

If you received a Sophie for a gift, or purchased one yourself, it's likely that you didn't read all the packaging. I certainly didn't, so I didn't know that (delightfully) Sophie is made in the same small French factory she started in, or that (reassuringly) she is painted with food-grade paint. Made from natural rubber, still exclusively sourced from special trees in Malaysia, this little giraffe is completely biodegradable and sustainable, as the trees aren't harmed by rubber extraction. 20

2. Forrest: She is also stylish and widely recognised, making her a popular choice for families.

分析: 文章写“fashionable/famous/social media”, 因此“widely recognised”能接受, 但是也带有推断成分哦, 写“fashionable”是比较安全的~

Question 2 (a)

Read Text C, Emil and the giraffes, in the insert and then answer Questions 2(a)–(d) on this question paper.

Question 2

- (a) Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words underlined:

- (i) The shipping director hardly takes his eyes off the papers on his desk as Emil is guided into the office.

第一次回答 IDK

第二次修改 barely looking up 1/1 ✓ (Accept close responses...)

- (ii) People creating spacesuits want to replicate the characteristics of giraffe skin.

第一次回答 imitate

第二次修改 mitate its qualities 0/1 ✗ (spelling error, answer intended correctly)

- (iii) The sailor explains the general features of how they intend to get the giraffes off the ship.

第一次回答 outlines

第二次修改 outlines the plan 1/1 ✓ (could be more detailed... outlines the plan for what? ➡ outlines the plan for

unloading)

- (iv) Emil speaks his concerns to the zoo manager.

voice my misgivings 1/1 ✓

Question 2 (b)

- (b) Using your own words, explain what the writer means by each of the words underlined:

That afternoon, I sit in the ship's library, sifting through documents estimating shipping costs, profit and loss, until I find the veterinary report. I make notes on the blood-pressure measurements recorded for one unfortunate giraffe before its voyage ended.

- (i) sifting

第一次回答 Looking through something carefully to find useful information.

第二次修改 Searching carefully through information to find something important. 1/1 ✓

(important ➡ 原文没有强调 "important")

- (ii) Estimating

第一次回答 Calculating or working out roughly.

第二次修改 Making a rough calculation or guess. 1/1 ✓

- (iii) recorded

第一次回答 Written down

第二次修改 Written down carefully so the information is kept for future reference. 1/1 ✓

(BUT "so the information is kept for future reference" ➡ 是Forrest自己理解的, 不是这个词本身的意思)

⚠
Question 2(b)只要求解释单词本身的意思, 而不是解释作者为什么这样做~
考试时建议尽量简洁, 只解释词义即可, 这样答案会更加准确!

Question 2 (c)

- (c) Use **one** example from the text below to explain how the writer suggests what Emil might be thinking and feeling during the ride in the lorry.

Use your own words in your explanation.

Days later, I'm journeying onwards to the zoo in a lorry carrying four of the giraffes, including Snowstorm. Bemused schoolchildren on buses catch sight of the giraffes and wave. The woods we pass are increasingly dense, not the vast, open woodlands giraffes dream of. We rattle along bumpy back roads, avoiding bridges, turning north towards the mountains along the border. 'Slower,' I tell the driver. The narrow window in the back of the cab seems to frame the giraffes' captivity. Their eyes are shut tight.

第二次修改:

The writer says, "The narrow window in the back of the cab seems to frame the giraffes' captivity." This suggests that Emil realises the giraffes are trapped and have lost their freedom. Seeing them through the small window makes him think of them as prisoners rather than wild animals, so he feels sad and sympathetic towards them.

1. Forrest: "The narrow window in the back of the cab seems to frame the giraffes' captivity." → 很棒，做到了先引用
2. Emil realises the giraffes are trapped and have lost their freedom. → captivity
3. Seeing them through the small window makes him think of them as prisoners rather than wild animals. → like prisoners
4. so he feels sad and sympathetic towards them. → sympathetic

3/3

Example正确

Meaning正确

Feeling正确

需要提升的地方:

"Seeing them through the small window..." 其实重点是 "frame"

因为 "frame" → picture frame → 把长颈鹿框起来 → 被限制，被展示 → 失去自由；所以，Forrest如果想让分析更深入，还可以进一步解释作者为什么使用 "frame" 这个词~

Question 2 (d)

(d) Reread paragraphs 12 and 16.

- Paragraph 12 begins 'One hour later ...' and is about the first encounter with the giraffes.
- Paragraph 16 begins 'Next morning ...' and is about the morning's activity at the port.

Explain how the writer uses language to convey meaning and to create effect in these paragraphs. Choose **three** examples of words or phrases from **each** paragraph to support your answer. Your choices should include the use of imagery.

Write about 200 to 300 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer.

In paragraph 12, the writer uses language to show that the giraffes are both beautiful and unusual. The phrase "scrape the sky" exaggerates how tall they are. It makes them seem huge and powerful, and shows how amazed Emil is when he first sees them. The simile "flow as if underwater" describes their slow and smooth movements. This makes the giraffes seem calm and graceful. The comparison "like enormous hand-puppets" creates a strange image because only their necks can be seen above the crates. It reminds us that they are trapped and controlled by humans instead of living freely.

In paragraph 16, the writer changes the mood to show the giraffes' fear. The phrase "panic at the sensation of flying" shows that the giraffes do not understand what is happening. They are frightened as they are lifted into the air. The image "shimmering hot with fear" suggests that their fear is so strong that it almost becomes visible. This helps the reader imagine how terrified they are. Finally, the sailor says, "They'll never walk on their continent again." This makes the reader feel sad because the giraffes will never return to their natural home. It also shows that they have lost their freedom forever. Overall, the writer uses these descriptions to make the reader admire the giraffes while also feeling sympathy for them and understanding Emil's growing sadness about what is happening.

14/15

Paragraph 12

1. scrape the sky (exaggerates how tall they are, huge and powerful, amazed Emil) ✓
2. flow as if underwater (slow, smooth, calm, graceful) ✓ 缺少 "otherworldly" 但问题不大 ~
3. enormous hand-puppets (trapped, controlled by humans, instead of living freely) ✓

Paragraph 16

1. panic at the sensation of flying (don't understand, frightened) ✓
2. shimmering hot with fear (fear almost becomes visible) ✓
3. They'll never walk... (never return, lost freedom forever, sad) ✓

New Reading Task - Text B - Question 1 (f) Summary

Read **Text B** and then answer **Question 1(f)** on the question paper.

Text B: Zozu's story

Zozu, like other white **storks** in Europe, typically flies to Africa for winter. Yet researchers tracking the bird using GPS discovered that he and a few pals skipped this year's gruelling migration across the Sahara Desert, stopping, instead, in cities like Madrid. Apparently, they'd developed a taste for the junk food in landfills (one shocking example featured in a recent book that turns data from studies tracing animal migration into a series of mind-blowing maps). reason 1 5

Nowadays, technology allows us to monitor, say, a herd of elephants or a flock of storks as they move across the globe. With global warming affecting migration routes, there's a new urgency in such research. It's bad news that many animals have stopped migrating: for example, parasites often have transmission stages requiring their host animal to stay in the same habitat, and speedy migration can avoid giving parasites a chance to take hold. reason 2 worrying 1 10

Zozu's story warns of one consequence as human populations become increasingly urban. Last year, researchers studied the effect of infrastructure in southern California, where mountain lion numbers are falling. Tracking the lions, researchers discovered their natural habitat was divided by eight lanes of traffic, houses and golf courses. Efforts to re-establish routes, using animal crossings such as underpasses, have failed. ? 表示原因的词还有: because, as, since reason 3 worrying 2 15

Meanwhile, in the traditional migration destinations of sub-Saharan Africa, reductions in the time migratory birds spend there have implications for the ecosystem, limiting insect consumption, seed dispersal and pollination. Analysis of bird records indicates that some migratory species are spending 60 fewer days on average in Africa each winter. If trends continue, some will eventually spend the full year within Europe where the longer presence of traditionally migratory birds could lead to increased competition for resources among resident non-migratory species. 影响 worrying 3 20

The book highlights the invaluable research generated by animal migration, citing insight applicable to aspects of human behaviour (baboons' movements as a group mirror crowd behaviour of human commuters). Monarch butterflies pictured in the book are just one species in decline – their migration an endangered activity since deforestation has destroyed potential stopover sites. worrying 5 25

Read **Text B, Zozu's story**, in the insert, and answer **Question 1(f)** on this question paper.

- (f) According to Text B, what are the reasons why changes to animal migrations have occurred and why are these changes worrying? 问题 1 : 动物迁徙为什么会发生变化? 问题 2 : 这些变化为什么令人担忧?

You must **use continuous writing** (not note form) and **use your own words** as far as possible.

Your summary should not be more than 120 words.

Up to 10 marks are available for the content of your answer and up to 5 marks for the quality of your writing.

New Reading Task - Text C - Question 2 (c-d) Vocabulary

Read **Text C** and then answer **Questions 2(a)–(d)** and **Question 3** on the question paper.

Text C: *The last migration*

This story is set some years in the future. A scientist, Lotta, is involved in a research project studying migratory birds called terns.

I'm watching when the bird is caught. Her wing clips the hair-thin wire, closing the basket gently over her. I approach, not breathing, reluctant to scare her. She ruffles feathers, a small burst of defiance before my fingers close around her. I have to be quick now, deftly looping the band over her leg. The plastic tightens firmly, securing the lightweight tracker. The tracker blinks once, confirming it's working. Her heartbeat pounds fast and fragile inside my palm. I place her back in her nest, edging away. She explodes free, swooping at me suddenly, giving a shrill cry. 5

I grin, thrilled. I've been out here for days, pecked a dozen times, but have now tagged three terns. My tent was blown into the sea last night. My cheap rental car's blessedly warm.

I check my notes again before setting off: Ennis Malone. Captain of the fishing boat *Raven* – in the days when there were fish to catch. 10

That evening, I find Ennis alone in the harbour café – a husk of a man. 'What would you say if I said I could find fish?' I say, opening the tracking software on my laptop and watching his eyebrows arch. The sight of blinking red lights melts me with relief. I'd no idea if this would work, but here they are, the three little birds that will fly south for the winter, taking me with them to learn their secrets. I'm not sure when dreaming of this last desperate project began, but it's part of me now as much as the instinct for breath. It swallowed me whole – a fantasy quest, securing a place on a fishing vessel and having its captain carry me far south following the longest natural migration of any living creature. 15

'I want to follow these birds,' I tell Ennis. 'They're part of the last colony.'

Ennis breathes out heavily, unsurprised. For decades, scientists warned about habitat destruction. Species after species were declared endangered, then extinct. There are no more monkeys in the rainforest, no bears in the once-frozen north, nor any other creature humankind hunted. Some birds remain, but there's no longer any funding for research. 20

'I've put trackers on three, but couldn't afford cameras,' I explain, doggedly following Ennis back to his vessel. 'They'll only help to pinpoint where the birds fly. Someone needs to witness how they survive, to learn. Take me south – we'll follow them. If there are fish left, those birds will find them.' 25

'No,' Ennis insists. 'There's no point.'

I wait all night on the harbour next to his boat. It's almost dawn when Ennis peers at me quizzically from the deck. 'You sure?' 30

I open the map I've made, showing him how the birds set out on separate paths, then merge together, following different routes to the fish. 'The spots vary,' I say. 'But the birds find them.' Wistfully, Ennis traces the lines on the map like memories through the Atlantic.

'Why did you name your boat after a bird, Ennis?' I ask.

'Because she flies too,' he smiles, nodding. 35

Months later, the remote shore ahead is magnificent – but empty. I'd told myself it was over when the signals stopped after the last storm; still somehow I'd hoped to see birds, or something, anything, alive. The boat can go no further, so we continue on foot towards the ridge – the only movement anywhere. My heart breaks and then jumps ... because something just flew across the sky. More somethings appear, swooping and soaring. I scramble to the summit and – oh, hundreds of terns smother an expanse of unspoiled ice below. Yet more dance upon the air. Dipping gracefully, diving hungrily, in a bay bubbling and thrashing with a million scales. Ennis reaches me with a low rumble of laughter, just as a huge whale fin crowns the sparkling surface. We gasp. What else is hiding in these clean, untouched waters – this sanctuary?

40

Read Text C, The last migration, in the insert and then answer Questions 2(a)–(d) on this question paper.

Question 2

- (a) Identify a word or phrase from the text which suggests the same idea as the words underlined:

- (i) The vehicle that Lotta hired was inexpensive.

Cheap[1] ✓

- (ii) Seeing the flashing signals on the computer screen stops Lotta worrying that the trackers will not work.

melts me with relief[1] ✗

- (iii) Even though there are still a few bird species left alive, there is no longer any money available to pay for scientists to study them.

there's no longer any funding for research[1] ✗ 划线内容是看错了吗？？

- (iv) Lotta explains how the migrating birds begin by taking different routes before they rejoin each other to find where the fish are.

merge together[1] ✓

- (b) Using your own words, explain what the writer means by each of the words underlined:

'I've put trackers on three, but couldn't afford cameras,' I explain, doggedly following Ennis back to his vessel. 'They'll only help to pinpoint where the birds fly. Someone needs to witness how they survive, to learn. Take me south – we'll follow them. If there are fish left, those birds will find them.'

- (i) vessel boat, ship[1] ✓

- (ii) pinpoint find the exact location[1] ✓

- (iii) witness see for themselves [1] ✓ 但是“see it personally”更好
因为 **witness** 还强调亲自到场观察某件事发生

Homework 1 - Text B - Question 1 (f) Summary

See page 7

Homework 2 - Text C - Question 2 (c-d)

- (c) Use **one** example from the text below to explain how the writer suggests Lotta's attitude to the project.

Use your own words in your explanation.

I'm not sure when dreaming of this last desperate project began, but it's part of me now as much as the instinct for breath. It swallowed me whole – a fantasy quest, securing a place on a fishing vessel and having its captain carry me far south following the longest natural migration of any living creature.

- (d) Reread paragraphs 1 and 13.

- Paragraph 1 begins 'I'm watching ...' and is about the actions of Lotta and the bird.
- Paragraph 13 begins 'Months later ...' and is about what Ennis and Lotta discover when they land at the end of their journey.

Explain how the writer uses language to convey meaning and to create effect in these paragraphs. Choose **three** examples of words or phrases from **each** paragraph to support your answer. Your choices should include the use of imagery.

Write about 200 to 300 words.

Up to 15 marks are available for the content of your answer.